16 They were snatched away before their time, and their foundations were swept
away by a flood.
17 They said to God, 'Depart from us. What can the Almighty do to us?'
18 But it was He who filled their houses with good things; so I stay far from the
counsel of the wicked.
19 The righteous see it and are glad; the innocent mock them:
20 'Surely our foes are destroyed, and fire has consumed their excess.'
21 Reconcile now and be at peace with Him; thereby good will come to you.
22 Receive instruction from His mouth, and lay up His words in your heart.
23 If you return to the Almighty, you will be restored. If you remove injustice
from your tents
24 and consign your gold to the dust and the gold of Ophir to the stones of
the ravines,
25 then the Almighty will be your gold and the finest silver for you.
26 Surely then you will delight in the Almighty and lift up your face to God.
27 You will pray to Him, and He will hear you, and you will fulfill your vows.
28 Your decisions will be carried out, and light will shine on your ways.
29 When men are brought low and you say, 'Lift them up!' then He will save
the lowly.
30 "He will deliver even one who is not innocent, rescuing him through the
cleanness of your hands."

23 Then Job answered:
2 "Even today my complaint is bitter. His hand is heavy despite my groaning."
3 If only I knew where to find Him, so that I could go to His seat.
4 I would plead my case before Him and fill my mouth with arguments.
5 I would learn how He would answer, and consider what He would say.
6 Would He contend with me in His great power? No, He would certainly take
note of me.
7 Then an upright man could reason with Him, and I would be delivered forever
from my Judge.
8 If I go east, He is not there, and if I go west, I cannot find Him.
9 When He is at work in the north, I cannot behold Him; when He turns to the
south, I cannot see Him.
10 Yet He knows the way I have taken; when He has tested me, I will come forth
as gold.
11 My feet have followed in His tracks; I have kept His way without turning aside.
12 I have not departed from the command of His lips; I have treasured the words
of His mouth more than my daily bread.
13 But He is unchangeable, and who can oppose Him? He does what He desires.
14 For He carries out His decree against me, and He has many such plans.
15 Therefore I am terrified in His presence; when I consider this, I fear Him.
16 God has made my heart faint; the Almighty has terrified me.
17 Yet I am not silenced by the darkness, by the thick darkness that covers my face.

24 "Why does the Almighty not reserve times for judgment? Why may those
who know Him never see His days?"
2 Men move boundary stones; they pasture stolen flocks.
3 They drive away the donkey of the fatherless and take the widow's ox in pledge.
4 They push the needy off the road and force all the poor of the land into hiding.
5 Indeed, like wild donkeys in the desert, the poor go to work foraging for food;
the wasteland is food for their children.
6 They gather fodder in the fields and glean the vineyards of the wicked.
7 Without clothing, they spend the night naked; they have no covering against
the cold.
8 Drenched by mountain rains, they huddle against the rocks for want of shelter.
9 The fatherless infant is snatched from the breast; the nursing child of the poor
is seized for a debt.
10 Without clothing, they wander about naked. They carry the sheaves, but still
go hungry.
11 They crush olives within their walls; they tread the winepresses, but go thirsty.
12 From the city, men groan, and the souls of the wounded cry out, yet God
charges no one with wrongdoing.
13 Then there are those who rebel against the light, not knowing its ways or
staying on its paths.
14 When daylight is gone, the murderer rises to kill the poor and needy; in the
night he is like a thief.
15 The eye of the adulterer watches for twilight. Thinking, 'No eye will see me,'
he covers his face.
16 In the dark they dig through houses; by day they shut themselves in, never to
experience the light.
17 For to them, deep darkness is their morning; surely they are friends with the
terrors of darkness!
18 They are but foam on the surface of the water; their portion of the land is
cursed, so that no one turns toward their vineyards.
19 As drought and heat consume the melting snow, so Sheol steals those who
have sinned.
20 The womb forgets them; the worm feeds on them; they are remembered no
more. So injustice is like a broken tree.
21 They prey on the barren and childless, and show no kindness to the widow.
22 Yet by His power, God drags away the mighty; though rising up, they have no
assurance of life.
23 He gives them a sense of security, but His eyes are on their ways.
24 They are exalted for a moment, then they are gone; they are brought low and
gathered up like all others; they are cut off like heads of grain.
25 "If this is not so, then who can prove me a liar and reduce my words
to nothing?"

25 Then Bildad the Shuhite replied:
2 "Dominion and awe belong to God; He establishes harmony in the heights
of heaven."
3 Can His troops be numbered? On whom does His light not rise?
4 How then can a man be just before God? How can one born of woman be pure?
5 If even the moon does not shine, and the stars are not pure in His sight,
6 "how much less man, who is but a maggot, and the son of man, who is but
a worm!"

26 Then Job answered:
2 "How you have helped the powerless and saved the arm that is feeble!"
3 How you have counseled the unwise and provided fully sound insight!
4 To whom have you uttered these words? And whose spirit spoke through you?
5 The dead tremble— those beneath the waters and those who dwell in them.
6 Sheol is naked before God, and Abaddon has no covering.
7 He stretches out the north over empty space; He hangs the earth upon nothing.
8 He wraps up the waters in His clouds, yet the clouds do not burst under their
own weight.
9 He covers the face of the full moon, spreading over it His cloud.
10 He has inscribed a horizon on the face of the waters at the boundary between
light and darkness.
11 The foundations of heaven quake, astounded at His rebuke.
12 By His power He stirred the sea; by His understanding He shattered Rahab.
13 By His breath the skies were cleared; His hand pierced the fleeing serpent.
14 "Indeed, these are but the fringes of His ways; how faint is the whisper we hear
of Him! Who then can understand the thunder of His power?"

27 Job continued his discourse:
2 "As surely as God lives, who has deprived me of justice— the Almighty, who
has embittered my soul—"
3 as long as my breath is still within me and the breath of God remains in
my nostrils,
4 my lips will not speak wickedness, and my tongue will not utter deceit.
5 I will never say that you are right; I will maintain my integrity until I die.
6 I will cling to my righteousness and never let go. As long as I live, my conscience
will not accuse me.
7 May my enemy be like the wicked and my opponent like the unjust.
8 For what is the hope of the godless when he is cut off, when God takes away
his life?
9 Will God hear his cry when distress comes upon him?
10 Will he delight in the Almighty? Will he call upon God at all times?
11 I will instruct you in the power of God. I will not conceal the ways of
the Almighty.
12 Surely all of you have seen it for yourselves. Why then do you keep up this
empty talk?
13 This is the wicked man's portion from God— the heritage the ruthless receive
from the Almighty.
14 Though his sons are many, they are destined for the sword; and his offspring
will never have enough food.
15 His survivors will be buried by the plague, and their widows will not weep
for them.
16 Though he heaps up silver like dust and piles up a wardrobe like clay,
17 what he lays up, the righteous will wear, and his silver will be divided by
the innocent.
18 The house he built is like a moth's cocoon, like a hut set up by a watchman.
19 He lies down wealthy, but will do so no more; when he opens his eyes, all
is gone.
20 Terrors overtake him like a flood; a tempest sweeps him away in the night.
21 The east wind carries him away, and he is gone; it sweeps him out of his place.
22 It hurls itself against him without mercy as he flees headlong from its power.
23 It claps its hands at him and hisses him out of his place.

28 "Surely there is a mine for silver and a place where gold is refined."
2 Iron is taken from the earth, and copper is smelted from ore.
3 Man puts an end to the darkness; he probes the farthest recesses for ore in
deepest darkness.
4 Far from human habitation he cuts a shaft in places forgotten by the foot of
man. Far from men he dangles and sways.
5 Food may come from the earth, but from below it is transformed as by fire.
6 Its rocks are the source of sapphires, containing flecks of gold.
7 No bird of prey knows that path; no falcon's eye has seen it.
8 Proud beasts have never trodden it; no lion has ever prowled over it.
9 The miner strikes the flint; he overturns mountains at their base.
10 He hews out channels in the rocks, and his eyes spot every treasure.

11 He stops up the sources of the streams to bring what is hidden to light.
12 But where can wisdom be found, and where does understanding dwell?
13 No man can know its value, nor is it found in the land of the living.
14 The ocean depths say, 'It is not in me,' while the sea declares, 'It is not with me.'
15 It cannot be bought with gold, nor can its price be weighed out in silver.
16 It cannot be valued in the gold of Ophir, in precious onyx or sapphire.
17 Neither gold nor crystal can compare to it, nor jewels of fine gold be exchanged for it.
18 Coral and quartz are unworthy of mention; the price of wisdom is beyond rubies.
19 Topaz from Cush cannot compare to it, nor can it be valued in pure gold.
20 From where then does wisdom come, and where does understanding dwell?
21 It is hidden from the eyes of every living thing and concealed from the birds of the air.
22 Abaddon and Death say, 'We have heard a rumor about it.'
23 But God understands its way, and He knows its place.
24 For He looks to the ends of the earth and sees everything under the heavens.
25 When God fixed the weight of the wind and measured out the waters,
26 when He set a limit for the rain and a path for the thunderbolt,
27 then He looked at wisdom and appraised it; He established it and searched it out.
28 "And He said to man, 'Behold, the fear of the Lord, that is wisdom, and to turn away from evil is understanding.'"

29 And Job continued his discourse:
2 "How I long for the months gone by, for the days when God watched over me,"
3 when His lamp shone above my head, and by His light I walked through the darkness,
4 when I was in my prime, when the friendship of God rested on my tent,
5 when the Almighty was still with me and my children were around me,
6 when my steps were bathed in cream and the rock poured out for me streams of oil!
7 When I went out to the city gate and took my seat in the public square,
8 the young men saw me and withdrew, and the old men rose to their feet.
9 The princes refrained from speaking and covered their mouths with their hands.
10 The voices of the nobles were hushed, and their tongues stuck to the roofs of their mouths.
11 For those who heard me called me blessed, and those who saw me commended me,
12 because I rescued the poor who cried out and the fatherless who had no helper.
13 The dying man blessed me, and I made the widow's heart sing for joy.
14 I put on righteousness, and it clothed me; justice was my robe and my turban.
15 I served as eyes to the blind and as feet to the lame.
16 I was a father to the needy, and I took up the case of the stranger.
17 I shattered the fangs of the unjust and snatched the prey from his teeth.
18 So I thought: 'I will die in my nest and multiply my days as the sand.'
19 My roots will spread out to the waters, and the dew will rest nightly on my branches.
20 My glory is ever new within me, and my bow is renewed in my hand.'
21 Men listened to me with expectation, waiting silently for my counsel.
22 After my words, they spoke no more; my speech settled on them like dew.
23 They waited for me as for rain and drank in my words like spring showers.
24 If I smiled at them, they did not believe it; the light of my countenance was precious.
25 I chose their course and presided as chief. So I dwelt as a king among his troops, as a comforter of the mourners.

30 "But now they mock me, men younger than I am, whose fathers I would have refused to entrust with my sheep dogs."
2 What use to me was the strength of their hands, since their vigor had left them?
3 Gaunt from poverty and hunger, they gnawed the dry land, and the desolate wasteland by night.
4 They plucked mallow among the shrubs, and the roots of the broom tree were their food.
5 They were banished from among men, shouted down like thieves,
6 so that they lived on the slopes of the wadis, among the rocks and in holes in the ground.
7 They cried out among the shrubs and huddled beneath the nettles.
8 A senseless and nameless brood, they were driven off the land.
9 And now they mock me in song; I have become a byword among them.
10 They abhor me and keep far from me; they do not hesitate to spit in my face.
11 Because God has unstrung my bow and afflicted me, they have cast off restraint in my presence.
12 The rabble arises at my right; they lay snares for my feet and build siege ramps against me.
13 They tear up my path; they profit from my destruction, with no one to restrain them.
14 They advance as through a wide breach; through the ruins they keep rolling in.
15 Terrors are turned loose against me; they drive away my dignity as by the wind, and my prosperity has passed like a cloud.
16 And now my soul is poured out within me; days of affliction grip me.
17 Night pierces my bones, and my gnawing pains never rest.
18 With great force He grasps my garment; He seizes me by the collar of my tunic.
19 He throws me into the mud, and I have become like dust and ashes.
20 I cry out to You for help, but You do not answer; when I stand up, You merely look at me.
21 You have ruthlessly turned on me; You oppose me with Your strong hand.
22 You snatch me up into the wind and drive me before it; You toss me about in the storm.
23 Yes, I know that You will bring me down to death, to the place appointed for all the living.
24 Yet no one stretches out his hand to a ruined man when he cries for help in his distress.
25 Have I not wept for those in trouble? Has my soul not grieved for the needy?
26 But when I hoped for good, evil came; when I looked for light, darkness fell.
27 I am churning within and cannot rest; days of affliction confront me.
28 I go about blackened, but not by the sun. I stand up in the assembly and cry for help.
29 I have become a brother of jackals, a companion of ostriches.
30 My skin grows black and peels, and my bones burn with fever.
31 My harp is tuned to mourning and my flute to the sound of weeping.

31 "I have made a covenant with my eyes. How then could I gaze with desire at a virgin?"
2 For what is the allotment of God from above, or the heritage from the Almighty on high?
3 Does not disaster come to the unjust and calamity to the workers of iniquity?
4 Does He not see my ways and count my every step?
5 If I have walked in falsehood or my foot has rushed to deceit,
6 let God weigh me with honest scales, that He may know my integrity.
7 If my steps have turned from the path, if my heart has followed my eyes, or if impurity has stuck to my hands,
8 then may another eat what I have sown, and may my crops be uprooted.
9 If my heart has been enticed by my neighbor's wife, or I have lurked at his door,
10 then may my own wife grind grain for another, and may other men sleep with her.
11 For that would be a heinous crime, an iniquity to be judged.
12 For it is a fire that burns down to Abaddon; it would root out my entire harvest.
13 If I have rejected the cause of my manservant or maidservant when they made a complaint against me,
14 what will I do when God rises to judge? How will I answer when called to account?
15 Did not He who made me in the womb also make them? Did not the same One form us in the womb?
16 If I have denied the desires of the poor or allowed the widow's eyes to fail,
17 if I have eaten my morsel alone, not sharing it with the fatherless—
18 though from my youth I reared him as would a father, and from my mother's womb I guided the widow—
19 if I have seen one perish for lack of clothing, or a needy man without a cloak,
20 if his heart has not blessed me for warming him with the fleece of my sheep,
21 if I have lifted up my hand against the fatherless because I saw that I had support in the gate,
22 then may my arm fall from my shoulder and be torn from its socket.
23 For calamity from God terrifies me, and His splendor I cannot overpower.
24 If I have put my trust in gold or called pure gold my security,
25 if I have rejoiced in my great wealth because my hand had gained so much,
26 if I have beheld the sun in its radiance or the moon moving in splendor,
27 so that my heart was secretly enticed and my hand threw a kiss from my mouth,
28 this would also be an iniquity to be judged, for I would have denied God on high.
29 If I have rejoiced in my enemy's ruin, or exulted when evil befell him—
30 I have not allowed my mouth to sin by asking for his life with a curse—
31 if the men of my house have not said, 'Who is there who has not had his fill?'—
32 but no stranger had to lodge on the street, for my door has been open to the traveler—
33 if I have covered my transgressions like Adam by hiding my guilt in my heart,
34 because I greatly feared the crowds and the contempt of the clans terrified me, so that I kept silent and would not go outside—
35 (Oh, that I had one to hear me! Here is my signature. Let the Almighty answer me; let my accuser compose an indictment.
36 Surely I would carry it on my shoulder and wear it like a crown.
37 I would give account of all my steps; I would approach Him like a prince.)—
38 if my land cries out against me and its furrows weep together,
39 if I have devoured its produce without payment or broken the spirit of its tenants,
40 "then let briers grow instead of wheat and stinkweed instead of barley." Thus conclude the words of Job.

32 So these three men stopped answering Job, because he was righteous in his own eyes.
2 This kindled the anger of Elihu son of Barachel the Buzite, of the family of Ram. He burned with anger against Job for justifying himself rather than God,

3 and he burned with anger against Job's three friends because they had failed to refute Job, and yet had condemned him.
4 Now Elihu had waited to speak to Job because the others were older than he.
5 But when he saw that the three men had no further reply, his anger was kindled.
6 So Elihu son of Barachel the Buzite declared: "I am young in years, while you are old; that is why I was timid and afraid to tell you what I know."
7 I thought that age should speak, and many years should teach wisdom.
8 But there is a spirit in a man, the breath of the Almighty, that gives him understanding.
9 It is not only the old who are wise, or the elderly who understand justice.
10 Therefore I say, 'Listen to me; I too will declare what I know.'
11 Indeed, I waited while you spoke; I listened to your reasoning; as you searched for words,
12 I paid you full attention. But no one proved Job wrong; not one of you rebutted his arguments.
13 So do not claim, 'We have found wisdom; let God, not man, refute him.'
14 But Job has not directed his words against me, and I will not answer him with your arguments.
15 Job's friends are dismayed, with no more to say; words have escaped them.
16 Must I wait, now that they are silent, now that they stand and no longer reply?
17 I too will answer; yes, I will declare what I know.
18 For I am full of words, and my spirit within me compels me.
19 Behold, my belly is like unvented wine; it is about to burst like a new wineskin.
20 I must speak and find relief; I must open my lips and respond.
21 I will be partial to no one, nor will I flatter any man.
22 For I do not know how to flatter, or my Maker would remove me in an instant.

33 "But now, O Job, hear my speech, and listen to all my words."
2 Behold, I will open my mouth; my address is on the tip of my tongue.
3 My words are from an upright heart, and my lips speak sincerely what I know.
4 The Spirit of God has made me, and the breath of the Almighty gives me life.
5 Refute me if you can; prepare your case and confront me.
6 I am just like you before God; I was also formed from clay.
7 Surely no fear of me should terrify you; nor will my hand be heavy upon you.
8 Surely you have spoken in my hearing, and I have heard these very words:
9 'I am pure, without transgression; I am clean, with no iniquity in me.'
10 Yet God finds occasions against me; He counts me as His enemy.
11 He puts my feet in the stocks; He watches over all my paths.'
12 Behold, you are not right in this matter. I will answer you, for God is greater than man.
13 Why do you complain to Him that He answers nothing a man asks?
14 For God speaks in one way and in another, yet no one notices.
15 In a dream, in a vision in the night, when deep sleep falls upon men as they slumber on their beds,
16 He opens their ears and terrifies them with warnings
17 to turn a man from wrongdoing and keep him from pride,
18 to preserve his soul from the Pit and his life from perishing by the sword.
19 A man is also chastened on his bed with pain and constant distress in his bones,
20 so that he detests his bread, and his soul loathes his favorite food.
21 His flesh wastes away from sight, and his hidden bones protrude.
22 He draws near to the Pit, and his life to the messengers of death.
23 Yet if there is a messenger on his side, one mediator in a thousand, to tell a man what is right for him,
24 to be gracious to him and say, 'Spare him from going down to the Pit; I have found his ransom,'
25 then his flesh is refreshed like a child's; he returns to the days of his youth.
26 He prays to God and finds favor; he sees God's face and shouts for joy, and God restores His righteousness to that man.
27 Then he sings before men with these words: 'I have sinned and perverted what was right; yet I did not get what I deserved.'
28 He redeemed my soul from going down to the Pit, and I will live to see the light.'
29 Behold, all these things God does to a man, two or even three times,
30 to bring back his soul from the Pit, that he may be enlightened with the light of life.
31 Pay attention, Job, and listen to me; be silent, and I will speak.
32 But if you have something to say, answer me; speak up, for I would like to vindicate you.
33 "But if not, then listen to me; be quiet, and I will teach you wisdom."

34 Then Elihu continued:
2 "Hear my words, O wise men; give ear to me, O men of learning."
3 For the ear tests words as the mouth tastes food.
4 Let us choose for ourselves what is right; let us learn together what is good.
5 For Job has declared, 'I am righteous, yet God has deprived me of justice.'
6 Would I lie about my case? My wound is incurable, though I am without transgression.'
7 What man is like Job, who drinks up derision like water?
8 He keeps company with evildoers and walks with wicked men.
9 For he has said, 'It profits a man nothing that he should delight in God.'
10 Therefore listen to me, O men of understanding. Far be it from God to do wrong, and from the Almighty to act unjustly.
11 For according to a man's deeds He repays him; according to a man's ways He brings consequences.
12 Indeed, it is true that God does not act wickedly, and the Almighty does not pervert justice.
13 Who gave Him charge over the earth? Who appointed Him over the whole world?
14 If He were to set His heart to it and withdraw His Spirit and breath,
15 all flesh would perish together and mankind would return to the dust.
16 If you have understanding, hear this; listen to my words.
17 Could one who hates justice govern? Will you condemn the just and mighty One,
18 who says to kings, 'You are worthless!' and to nobles, 'You are wicked,'
19 who is not partial to princes and does not favor rich over poor? For they are all the work of His hands.
20 They die in an instant, in the middle of the night. The people convulse and pass away; the mighty are removed without human hand.
21 For His eyes are on the ways of a man, and He sees his every step.
22 There is no darkness or deep shadow where the workers of iniquity can hide.
23 For God need not examine a man further or have him approach for judgment.
24 He shatters the mighty without inquiry and sets up others in their place.
25 Therefore, He recognizes their deeds; He overthrows them in the night and they are crushed.
26 He strikes them for their wickedness in full view,
27 because they turned aside from Him and had no regard for any of His ways.
28 They caused the cry of the poor to come before Him, and He heard the outcry of the afflicted.
29 But when He remains silent, who can condemn Him? When He hides His face, who can see Him? Yet He watches over both man and nation,
30 that godless men should not rule or lay snares for the people.
31 Suppose someone says to God, 'I have endured my punishment; I will offend no more.'
32 Teach me what I cannot see; if I have done wrong, I will not do it again.'
33 Should God repay you on your own terms when you have disavowed His? You must choose, not I; so tell me what you know.
34 Men of understanding will declare to me, and the wise men who hear me will say:
35 'Job speaks without knowledge; his words lack insight.'
36 If only Job were tried to the utmost for answering like a wicked man.
37 "For he adds rebellion to his sin; he claps his hands among us and multiplies his words against God."

35 And Elihu went on to say:
2 "Do you think this is just? You say, 'I am more righteous than God.'"
3 For you ask, 'What does it profit me, and what benefit do I gain apart from sin?'
4 I will reply to you and to your friends as well.
5 Look to the heavens and see; gaze at the clouds high above you.
6 If you sin, what do you accomplish against Him? If you multiply your transgressions, what do you do to Him?
7 If you are righteous, what do you give Him, or what does He receive from your hand?
8 Your wickedness affects only a man like yourself, and your righteousness only a son of man.
9 Men cry out under great oppression; they plead for relief from the arm of the mighty.
10 But no one asks, 'Where is God my Maker, who gives us songs in the night,'
11 who teaches us more than the beasts of the earth and makes us wiser than the birds of the air?'
12 There they cry out, but He does not answer, because of the pride of evil men.
13 Surely God does not listen to empty pleas, and the Almighty does not take note of it.
14 How much less, then, when you say that you do not see Him, that your case is before Him and you must wait for Him,
15 and further, that in His anger He has not punished or taken much notice of folly!
16 "So Job opens his mouth in vain and multiplies words without knowledge."

36 And Elihu continued:
2 "Bear with me a little longer, and I will show you that there is more to be said on God's behalf."
3 I get my knowledge from afar, and I will ascribe justice to my Maker.
4 For truly my words are free of falsehood; one perfect in knowledge is with you.
5 Indeed, God is mighty, but He despises no one; He is mighty in strength of understanding.
6 He does not keep the wicked alive, but He grants justice to the afflicted.
7 He does not take His eyes off the righteous, but He enthrones them with kings and exalts them forever.
8 And if men are bound with chains, caught in cords of affliction,
9 then He tells them their deeds and how arrogantly they have transgressed.
10 He opens their ears to correction and commands that they turn from iniquity.

11 If they obey and serve Him, then they end their days in prosperity and their years in happiness.
12 But if they do not obey, then they perish by the sword and die without knowledge.
13 The godless in heart harbor resentment; even when He binds them, they do not cry for help.
14 They die in their youth, among the male shrine prostitutes.
15 God rescues the afflicted by their affliction and opens their ears in oppression.
16 Indeed, He drew you from the jaws of distress to a spacious and broad place, to a table full of richness.
17 But now you are laden with the judgment due the wicked; judgment and justice have seized you.
18 Be careful that no one lures you with riches; do not let a large bribe lead you astray.
19 Can your wealth or all your mighty effort keep you from distress?
20 Do not long for the night, when people vanish from their homes.
21 Be careful not to turn to iniquity, for this you have preferred to affliction.
22 Behold, God is exalted in His power. Who is a teacher like Him?
23 Who has appointed His way for Him, or told Him, 'You have done wrong'?
24 Remember to magnify His work, which men have praised in song.
25 All mankind has seen it; men behold it from afar.
26 Indeed, God is great—beyond our knowledge; the number of His years is unsearchable.
27 For He draws up drops of water which distill the rain from the mist,
28 which the clouds pour out and shower abundantly on mankind.
29 Furthermore, who can understand how the clouds spread out, how the thunder roars from His pavilion?
30 See how He scatters His lightning around Him and covers the depths of the sea.
31 For by these He judges the nations and provides food in abundance.
32 He fills His hands with lightning and commands it to strike its mark.
33 The thunder declares His presence; even the cattle regard the rising storm.

37 "At this my heart also pounds and leaps from its place."
2 Listen closely to the thunder of His voice and the rumbling that comes from His mouth.
3 He unleashes His lightning beneath the whole sky and sends it to the ends of the earth.
4 Then there comes a roaring sound; He thunders with His majestic voice. He does not restrain the lightning when His voice resounds.
5 God thunders wondrously with His voice; He does great things we cannot comprehend.
6 For He says to the snow, 'Fall on the earth,' and to the gentle rain, 'Pour out a mighty downpour.'
7 He seals up the hand of every man, so that all men may know His work.
8 The wild animals enter their lairs; they settle down in their dens.
9 The tempest comes from its chamber, and the cold from the driving north winds.
10 By the breath of God the ice is formed and the watery expanses are frozen.
11 He loads the clouds with moisture; He scatters His lightning through them.
12 They swirl about, whirling at His direction, accomplishing all that He commands over the face of all the earth.
13 Whether for punishment or for His land, He accomplishes this in His loving devotion.
14 Listen to this, O Job; stand still and consider the wonders of God.
15 Do you know how God dispatches the clouds or makes the lightning flash?
16 Do you understand how the clouds float, those wonders of Him who is perfect in knowledge?
17 You whose clothes get hot when the land lies hushed under the south wind,
18 can you, like Him, spread out the skies to reflect the heat like a mirror of bronze?
19 Teach us what we should say to Him; we cannot draw up our case when our faces are in darkness.
20 Should He be told that I want to speak? Would a man ask to be swallowed up?
21 Now no one can gaze at the sun when it is bright in the skies after the wind has swept them clean.
22 Out of the north He comes in golden splendor; awesome majesty surrounds Him.
23 The Almighty is beyond our reach; He is exalted in power! In His justice and great righteousness He does not oppress.
24 "Therefore, men fear Him, for He is not partial to the wise in heart."

38 Then the LORD answered Job out of the whirlwind and said:
2 "Who is this who obscures My counsel by words without knowledge?"
3 Now brace yourself like a man; I will question you, and you shall inform Me.
4 Where were you when I laid the foundations of the earth? Tell Me, if you have understanding.
5 Who fixed its measurements? Surely you know! Or who stretched a measuring line across it?
6 On what were its foundations set, or who laid its cornerstone,
7 while the morning stars sang together and all the sons of God shouted for joy?
8 Who enclosed the sea behind doors when it burst forth from the womb,
9 when I made the clouds its garment and thick darkness its blanket,
10 when I fixed its boundaries and set in place its bars and doors,
11 and I declared: 'You may come this far, but no farther; here your proud waves must stop'?
12 In your days, have you commanded the morning or assigned the dawn its place,
13 that it might spread to the ends of the earth and shake the wicked out of it?
14 The earth takes shape like clay under a seal; its hills stand out like the folds of a garment.
15 Light is withheld from the wicked, and their upraised arm is broken.
16 Have you journeyed to the vents of the sea or walked in the trenches of the deep?
17 Have the gates of death been revealed to you? Have you seen the gates of the shadow of death?
18 Have you surveyed the extent of the earth? Tell Me, if you know all this.
19 Where is the way to the home of light? Do you know where darkness resides,
20 so you can lead it back to its border? Do you know the paths to its home?
21 Surely you know, for you were already born! And the number of your days is great!
22 Have you entered the storehouses of snow or observed the storehouses of hail,
23 which I hold in reserve for times of trouble, for the day of war and battle?
24 In which direction is the lightning dispersed, or the east wind scattered over the earth?
25 Who cuts a channel for the flood or clears a path for the thunderbolt,
26 to bring rain on a barren land, on a desert where no man lives,
27 to satisfy the parched wasteland and make it sprout with tender grass?
28 Does the rain have a father? Who has begotten the drops of dew?
29 From whose womb does the ice emerge? Who gives birth to the frost from heaven,
30 when the waters become hard as stone and the surface of the deep is frozen?
31 Can you bind the chains of the Pleiades or loosen the belt of Orion?
32 Can you bring forth the constellations in their seasons or lead out the Bear and her cubs?
33 Do you know the laws of the heavens? Can you set their dominion over the earth?
34 Can you command the clouds so that a flood of water covers you?
35 Can you send the lightning bolts on their way? Do they report to you, 'Here we are'?
36 Who has put wisdom in the heart or given understanding to the mind?
37 Who has the wisdom to count the clouds? Or who can tilt the water jars of the heavens
38 when the dust hardens into a mass and the clods of earth stick together?
39 Can you hunt the prey for a lioness or satisfy the hunger of young lions
40 when they crouch in their dens and lie in wait in the thicket?
41 Who provides food for the raven when its young cry out to God as they wander about for lack of food?

39 "Do you know when mountain goats give birth? Have you watched the doe bear her fawn?"
2 Can you count the months they are pregnant? Do you know the time they give birth?
3 They crouch down and bring forth their young; they deliver their newborn.
4 Their young ones thrive and grow up in the open field; they leave and do not return.
5 Who set the wild donkey free? Who released the swift donkey from the harness?
6 I made the wilderness his home and the salt flats his dwelling.
7 He scorns the tumult of the city and never hears the shouts of a driver.
8 He roams the mountains for pasture, searching for any green thing.
9 Will the wild ox consent to serve you? Will he stay by your manger at night?
10 Can you hold him to the furrow with a harness? Will he plow the valleys behind you?
11 Can you rely on his great strength? Will you leave your hard work to him?
12 Can you trust him to bring in your grain and gather it to your threshing floor?
13 The wings of the ostrich flap joyfully, but cannot match the pinions and feathers of the stork.
14 For she leaves her eggs on the ground and lets them warm in the sand.
15 She forgets that a foot may crush them, or a wild animal may trample them.
16 She treats her young harshly, as if not her own, with no concern that her labor was in vain.
17 For God has deprived her of wisdom; He has not endowed her with understanding.
18 Yet when she proudly spreads her wings, she laughs at the horse and its rider.
19 Do you give strength to the horse or adorn his neck with a mane?
20 Do you make him leap like a locust, striking terror with his proud snorting?
21 He paws in the valley and rejoices in his strength; he charges into battle.
22 He laughs at fear, frightened of nothing; he does not turn back from the sword.
23 A quiver rattles at his side, along with a flashing spear and lance.
24 Trembling with excitement, he devours the distance; he cannot stand still when the ram's horn sounds.
25 At the blast of the horn, he snorts with fervor. He catches the scent of battle from afar— the shouts of captains and the cry of war.

[26] Does the hawk take flight by your understanding and spread his wings toward the south?
[27] Does the eagle soar at your command and make his nest on high?
[28] He dwells on a cliff and lodges there; his stronghold is on a rocky crag.
[29] From there he spies out food; his eyes see it from afar.
[30] "His young ones feast on blood; and where the slain are, there he is."

40 And the LORD said to Job:
[2] "Will the faultfinder contend with the Almighty? Let him who argues with God give an answer."
[3] Then Job answered the LORD:
[4] "Behold, I am insignificant. How can I reply to You? I place my hand over my mouth."
[5] "I have spoken once, but I have no answer— twice, but I have nothing to add."
[6] Then the LORD answered Job out of the whirlwind and said:
[7] "Now brace yourself like a man; I will question you, and you shall inform Me."
[8] Would you really annul My justice? Would you condemn Me to justify yourself?
[9] Do you have an arm like God's? Can you thunder with a voice like His?
[10] Then adorn yourself with majesty and splendor, and clothe yourself with honor and glory.
[11] Unleash the fury of your wrath; look on every proud man and bring him low.
[12] Look on every proud man and humble him; trample the wicked where they stand.
[13] Bury them together in the dust; imprison them in the grave.
[14] Then I will confess to you that your own right hand can save you.
[15] Look at Behemoth, which I made along with you. He feeds on grass like an ox.
[16] See the strength of his loins and the power in the muscles of his belly.
[17] His tail sways like a cedar; the sinews of his thighs are tightly knit.
[18] His bones are tubes of bronze; his limbs are rods of iron.
[19] He is the foremost of God's works; only his Maker can draw the sword against him.
[20] The hills yield him their produce, while all the beasts of the field play nearby.
[21] He lies under the lotus plants, hidden among the reeds of the marsh.
[22] The lotus plants conceal him in their shade; the willows of the brook surround him.
[23] Though the river rages, Behemoth is unafraid; he remains secure, though the Jordan surges to his mouth.
[24] Can anyone capture him as he looks on, or pierce his nose with a snare?

41 "Can you pull in Leviathan with a hook or tie down his tongue with a rope?"
[2] Can you put a cord through his nose or pierce his jaw with a hook?
[3] Will he beg you for mercy or speak to you softly?
[4] Will he make a covenant with you to take him as a slave for life?
[5] Can you pet him like a bird or put him on a leash for your maidens?
[6] Will traders barter for him or divide him among the merchants?
[7] Can you fill his hide with harpoons or his head with fishing spears?
[8] If you lay a hand on him, you will remember the battle and never repeat it!
[9] Surely hope of overcoming him is false. Is not the sight of him overwhelming?
[10] No one is so fierce as to rouse Leviathan. Then who is able to stand against Me?
[11] Who has given to Me that I should repay him? Everything under heaven is Mine.
[12] I cannot keep silent about his limbs, his power and graceful form.
[13] Who can strip off his outer coat? Who can approach him with a bridle?
[14] Who can open his jaws, ringed by his fearsome teeth?
[15] His rows of scales are his pride, tightly sealed together.
[16] One scale is so near to another that no air can pass between them.
[17] They are joined to one another; they clasp and cannot be separated.
[18] His snorting flashes with light, and his eyes are like the rays of dawn.
[19] Firebrands stream from his mouth; fiery sparks shoot forth!
[20] Smoke billows from his nostrils as from a boiling pot over burning reeds.
[21] His breath sets coals ablaze, and flames pour from his mouth.
[22] Strength resides in his neck, and dismay leaps before him.
[23] The folds of his flesh are tightly joined; they are firm and immovable.
[24] His chest is as hard as a rock, as hard as a lower millstone!
[25] When Leviathan rises up, the mighty are terrified; they withdraw before his thrashing.
[26] The sword that reaches him has no effect, nor does the spear or dart or arrow.
[27] He regards iron as straw and bronze as rotten wood.
[28] No arrow can make him flee; slingstones become like chaff to him.
[29] A club is regarded as straw, and he laughs at the sound of the lance.
[30] His undersides are jagged potsherds, spreading out the mud like a threshing sledge.
[31] He makes the depths seethe like a cauldron; he makes the sea like a jar of ointment.
[32] He leaves a glistening wake behind him; one would think the deep had white hair!
[33] Nothing on earth is his equal— a creature devoid of fear!
[34] "He looks down on all the haughty; he is king over all the proud."

42 Then Job replied to the LORD:
[2] "I know that You can do all things and that no plan of Yours can be thwarted."
[3] You asked, 'Who is this who conceals My counsel without knowledge?' Surely I spoke of things I did not understand, things too wonderful for me to know.
[4] You said, 'Listen now, and I will speak. I will question you, and you shall inform Me.'
[5] My ears had heard of You, but now my eyes have seen You.
[6] "Therefore I retract my words, and I repent in dust and ashes."
[7] After the LORD had spoken these words to Job, He said to Eliphaz the Temanite, "My wrath is kindled against you and your two friends. For you have not spoken about Me accurately, as My servant Job has."
[8] "So now, take seven bulls and seven rams, go to My servant Job, and sacrifice a burnt offering for yourselves. Then My servant Job will pray for you, for I will accept his prayer and not deal with you according to your folly. For you have not spoken accurately about Me, as My servant Job has."
[9] So Eliphaz the Temanite, Bildad the Shuhite, and Zophar the Naamathite went and did as the LORD had told them; and the LORD accepted Job's request.
[10] After Job had prayed for his friends, the LORD restored his prosperity and doubled his former possessions.
[11] All his brothers and sisters and prior acquaintances came and dined with him in his house. They consoled him and comforted him over all the adversity that the LORD had brought upon him. And each one gave him a piece of silver and a gold ring.
[12] So the LORD blessed Job's latter days more than his first. He owned 14,000 sheep, 6,000 camels, 1,000 yoke of oxen, and 1,000 female donkeys.
[13] And he also had seven sons and three daughters.
[14] He named his first daughter Jemimah, his second Keziah, and his third Keren-happuch.
[15] No women as beautiful as Job's daughters could be found in all the land, and their father granted them an inheritance among their brothers.
[16] After this, Job lived 140 years and saw his children and their children to the fourth generation.
[17] And so Job died, old and full of years.

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